

Industrial Security (Bachelor)

Solution Sheet – Section 05

Threat Landscape

Exercise 5.1 – ATT&CK Mapping (Stuxnet sample)

Tactic	Technique ID	Detection idea
Initial Access	T0862 Replication via removable media	USB telemetry; allow-list peripherals
Execution	T0871 Execution through API	Audit Step7 DLL load events
Persistence	T0859 Valid accounts	Alert on new admin sessions on eng WS
Lateral Movement	T0859 Valid accounts (SMB)	SMB anomaly detection between L2 and L3
Inhibit Response	T0856 Spoof Reporting Message	Compare HMI tags vs raw PLC tags via diff
Impact	T0833 Modify parameter	PLC code change-control + checksum monitoring

Exercise 5.2 – Shodan observations

Typical findings: hundreds of Modbus endpoints (often building automation), bare Siemens PLCs without firewalls (residential PV inverters, water utilities), Unitronics PLCs with default port and password. Asset owners must remove direct Internet exposure, replace defaults, and use VPN/jump hosts. CERTs/ISPs can notify owners via WHOIS or sectoral channels (e.g. Shadowserver).

Exercise 5.3 – Threat Modelling (sample)

Ranking for a regional speciality-chemicals site (most → least likely):

1. Cybercrime / ransomware (high financial motive, low cost).
2. Insider (former contractor).
3. Hactivist (industry visibility).
4. Competitor / industrial espionage.
5. Nation-state APT (only if of strategic interest).

Sample ransomware path: phishing → corporate AD → vendor jump host → engineering WS → lateral to Historian → encryption. Choke points: MFA, EDR, segmentation between iDMZ and L2/3, offline backups.

Exercise 5.4 – Supply Chain Response

Compensating controls: block ingress to vulnerable service on the firewall, deploy a virtual patch on the IPS, disable the vulnerable feature where possible, enable enhanced logging.
Inform: plant manager, OT/IT security leads, process safety, vendor account team, legal (in

case of regulatory disclosure).

Executive briefing: explain in business terms – “a critical flaw affects N PLCs; we have temporary controls in place that reduce, but do not eliminate, the risk. Vendor patch in Q . . . , plant outage required.”